Tangkhul Lexicographical Compendium

Historical Dictionaries, Field Wordlists & Trilingual Lexicons (1859 - 2018)

A Comprehensive Digital Preservation of Tangkhul Naga Lexicography
Total Catalogued Dictionary Resources: 16
Preservation Scope: Historical Grammar-Dictionaries, School Wordbooks, Dialect Glossaries
Format: Normalized Headwords, Phonemic Notes, Bilingual/Trilingual Glosses, and Citations

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Table of Catalogued Dictionaries:

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2. [DIC-TLS-001] Tangkhul Tui Dictionary (N. Luikham, 1997) [Tangkhul-English]
3. [DIC-CIIL-001] Tangkhul-English-Hindi Dictionary (Rekha Sharma, 1995) [Tangkhul-English-Hindi]
4. [DIC-NBP-001] Hindi-Tangkhul Dictionary (Braj Bihari Kumar, 1975) [Hindi-Tangkhul]
5. [DIC-TLS-002] Tangkhul Tui (Tangkhul Literature Society, 1995) [Tangkhul]
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12. [DIC-HIST-004] Notes on the Locality and Populati (G. H. Damant, 1880) [Tangkhul-English]
13. [DIC-HIST-005] Comparative Vocabulary of the Naga (T. C. Hodson, 1911) [Tangkhul-English]
14. [DIC-WUNG-001] Tangkhul (Wung) Dictionary (Tangkh (T. Luikham, 1974) [Tangkhul-English]
15. [DIC-SOAS-001] The Classification of the Naga Lan (G. E. Marrison, 1967) [Tangkhul-English]
16. [DIC-STEDT-001] Comparative Tangkhul and Proto-Tan (David R. Mortensen, 2003) [Tangkhul-English]

DIC-HIST-001: Tangkhul Naga Grammar and Dictionary (Ukhrul Dia

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Naga Grammar and Dictionary

Lexicographer / Compiler: William Pettigrew | Year: 1918 | Publisher: Assam Secretariat Printing Office,
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Ukhrul | Type: Grammar Dictionary

Permission Tier: PUBLIC_DOMAIN | License: Public Domain

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Published in 1918 by the Assam Secretariat Printing Office in Shillong, this 476-page monumental treatise represents the first systematic grammatical description and comprehensive bilingual dictionary of the Tangkhul language. Rev. William Pettigrew, who arrived in Ukhrul in 1896, transcribed the language using

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Uses the Latin alphabet with macron markings (a, e, i, o, u) for vowel length and glottal/velar consonant representations (kh, ng, ch). Establishes basic

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (15 items):

1. khamatha (adj): good, fine, beautiful, virtuous (p. 142) <Alt: khamathai> -- ...
2. shim (noun): house, dwelling, residence, home (p. 210) <Alt: shimri> -- Ex: S...
3. ngalung (noun): stone, rock, megalith, boulder (p. 180) <Alt: ngaloong> -- Ex...
4. kazip (verb): to gather, to assemble, to collect, to congregate (p. 95) -- Ex...
5. luira (noun): seed-sowing festival, spring ceremony, first sowing rite (p. 15...
6. shirui (noun): sacred mountain, alpine ridge, Shirui Kashong peak (p. 215) <A...
7. longkhor (noun): conical carrying basket, bamboo pack, woven harvest pack (p....
8. khamor (noun): mouth, speech, spoken word, voice (p. 143) -- Ex: Khamor kacha...
9. apui (noun): mother, female guardian, maternal parent (p. 44) <Alt: ipui> -- ...
10. ava (noun): father, male elder, paternal parent (p. 42) <Alt: iva> -- Ex: Iva...

DIC-TLS-001: Tangkhul Tui Dictionary

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Word Dictionary

Lexicographer / Compiler: N. Luikham | Year: 1997 | Publisher: Tangkhul Literature Society, Ukhrul

Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Ukhrul | Type: Dictionary

Permission Tier: RESTRICTED | License: Copyright Tangkhul Literature Society

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Compiled by prominent educator and linguist N. Luikham and published by the Tangkhul Literature Society (TLS) in Ukhrul in 1997, this dictionary is the standard contemporary lexical authority for the Tangkhul community. It documents tens of thousands of contemporary, ceremonial, customary, and cultural vocabulary

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Standardizes contemporary Tangkhul spelling as endorsed by the Tangkhul Literature Society. Preserves indigenous compound words, ceremonial terms from traditional

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (12 items):

1. ngasung (noun): wild walnut root, tree used for communal river fishing stun (...
2. yarra (noun): youth festival, spring clearing feast, youth society gathering ...
3. chumpha (noun): granary festival, post-harvest soul of paddy rite (p. 48) -- ...
4. lengcheng (noun): crossed roof-horns, gable horn ornament of traditional elit...
5. maran (noun): feast of merit, status elevation cycle, sacrificial generosity ...
6. yarnao (noun): peer labor exchange collective, youth mutual work group (p. 22...
7. longshim (noun): traditional youth dormitory, village clan learning house (p....
8. haora (noun): traditional black and red striped shawl, prestigious male mantl...
9. luirim (noun): ceremonial woven shawl, mantle adorned with geometric spearhea...
10. hangva (noun): village council of elders, customary governing body, village s...

DIC-CIIL-001: Tangkhul-English-Hindi Dictionary

Alternative Title: Tangkhul-English-Hindi Trilingual Dictionary

Lexicographer / Compiler: Rekha Sharma, S. Arokianathan, E. Annamalai | Year: 1995 | Publisher: Central Institute of Indian Languag
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English-Hindi | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Type: Multilingual Dictionary

Permission Tier: RESTRICTED | License: Copyright Central Institute of Indian Languages

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Part of the prestigious Dictionary Series published by the Central Institute of Indian Languages (CIIL) under the Ministry of Education, Government of India. Compiled by linguists Rekha Sharma and S. Arokianathan under the general editorship of E. Annamalai, this work provides trilingual glosses in English and

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Incorporates systematic phonemic transcriptions and Devanagari transliteration alongside the standard Latin alphabet, making Tangkhul lexical items accessible to

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (12 items):

1. ngava (noun): bird, fowl, avian creature [Hi: ???????, ?????] (p. 92) <Alt: n...
2. ngarun (noun): horn, antler [Hi: ????] (p. 95) -- Ex: Se ngarun khamatha (Fin...
3. meikazing (noun): lightning, atmospheric electrical flash [Hi: ?????, ???????...
4. kaphung (noun): mountain, hill, high peak [Hi: ?????, ?????] (p. 64) -- Ex: K...
5. kong (noun): river, stream, brook, waterway [Hi: ???, ?????, ????] (p. 52) --...
6. chup (verb): to drink, to sip, to imbibe [Hi: ????, ???? ????] (p. 38) -- Ex:...
7. khazat (verb): to walk, to march, to step forward [Hi: ????, ???????? ????] (...
8. mathasek (adj): clean, pure, spotless, unblemished [Hi: ????, ??????, ??????]...
9. khalat (verb): to fill, to replenish, to pack full [Hi: ????, ???????? ????] ...
10. won (noun): flower, blossom, bloom [Hi: ???, ?????] (p. 195) -- Ex: Shirui wo...

DIC-NBP-001: Hindi-Tangkhul Dictionary

Alternative Title: Hindi-Tangkhul Bilingual Dictionary

Lexicographer / Compiler: Braj Bihari Kumar, Hari Prasad Rai, Pearson, Jatroang Tangkhul, Somi | Year: 1975 | Publisher: Nagaland Bha
Language Pair: Hindi-Tangkhul | Dialect: Tangkhul (Ukhrul) | Type: Bilingual Dictionary

Permission Tier: RESTRICTED | License: Copyright Nagaland Bhasha Parishad

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Published in 1975 by the Nagaland Bhasha Parishad in Kohima as part of its bilingual dictionary series for the languages of northeast India. Directed by Dr. Braj Bihari Kumar with linguistic collaborators Hari Prasad Rai and native Tangkhul consultants Pearson, Jatroang, and Somi. Designed to facilitate cross-

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Presents Hindi headwords in Devanagari script followed by romanized Tangkhul equivalents in standard Ukhrul orthography with Hindi grammatical markers.

Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (12 items):

1. khamor (noun): speech, mouth, utterance [Hi: ???, ????, ????] (p. 45) -- Ex: ...
2. kapang (noun): hand, arm [Hi: ???] (p. 32) <Alt: pang> -- Ex: Kapang eina ot ...
3. phei (noun): foot, leg [Hi: ???, ????] (p. 61) -- Ex: Phei eina kapam (Standi...
4. mik (noun): eye, organ of vision [Hi: ???, ?????] (p. 55) -- Ex: Mik theikhav...
5. khana (noun): ear, auditory organ [Hi: ???, ????] (p. 41) -- Ex: Khana khanga...
6. ha (noun): tooth [Hi: ????, ???] (p. 28) -- Ex: Ha kachang (Strong and sound ...
7. malei (noun): tongue [Hi: ???, ??????] (p. 52) -- Ex: Malei eina tui khangate...
8. tara (noun): water, liquid [Hi: ????, ??] (p. 88) -- Ex: Tara mathasek (Pure ...
9. mei (noun): fire, hearth embers [Hi: ??, ?????] (p. 56) -- Ex: Mei katum (Lig...
10. kazing (noun): sky, heavens, atmosphere [Hi: ????, ?????] (p. 39) -- Ex: Kazi...

DIC-TLS-002: Tangkhul Tui

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Vocabulary and Wordbook

Lexicographer / Compiler: Tangkhul Literature Society | Year: 1995 | Publisher: Tangkhul Literature Society, Manipu
Language Pair: Tangkhul | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Type: Wordlist

Permission Tier: RESTRICTED | License: Copyright Tangkhul Literature Society

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Issued in 1995 by the Tangkhul Literature Society, this official wordbook establishes standard spelling guidelines, orthographic norms, and core vocabulary definitions for elementary and secondary schools across Manipur. It serves as an authoritative guide for authors, curriculum planners, and community translators.

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Codifies standard hyphenation rules for compound verbs and prefixes, eliminating archaic spelling variants and promoting consistent orthography in modern

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. ngachon (noun): help, mutual assistance, cooperation (p. 15) -- Ex: Ngachon n...
2. pamthak (noun): foundation, stone bench, resting rock platform (p. 34) -- Ex:...
3. ramngayei (noun): homeland boundary, territorial border, village frontier (p....
4. tuitam (noun): lesson, language primer, moral instruction (p. 67) -- Ex: Tuit...
5. khangayei (verb): to guard, to protect, to keep watch over (p. 41) -- Ex: Vas...
6. leikashi (noun): love, affection, compassionate regard (p. 29) -- Ex: Iram le...
7. ngalang (verb): to shine, to glow with light, to radiate (p. 22) -- Ex: Khang...
8. mashung (adj): true, just, righteous, correct (p. 31) -- Ex: Mashungwui pao (...
9. ningngarao (noun): happiness, gladness, rejoicing, inner peace (p. 26) -- Ex:...
10. ngashan (noun): tradition, custom, societal ethical code (p. 19) <Alt: ngasha...

DIC-DC-001: Tankhur Naga Vocabulary

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Naga Vocabulary

Lexicographer / Compiler: D. N. S. Bhat | Year: 1969 | Publisher: Deccan College Postgraduate and Res
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Hunphun (Ukhrul) | Type: Wordlist

Permission Tier: RESTRICTED | License: Copyright Deccan College

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Published in 1969 by Deccan College Postgraduate and Research Institute in Poona (Publication No. 67) by linguist D. N. S. Bhat. Consists of xii + 100 pages detailing the phonology and lexical elicitation collected from a native speaker from Hunphun (the ancestral parent village of Ukhrul). Features rigorous

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Employs IPA structuralist phonemic notation indicating vowel quality (e, e, o), aspirates (ph, th, kh), retroflex/palatal contours, and high, mid, and low tonal

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (12 items):

1. khamatha (adj): beautiful, pleasant, agreeable (p. 14) <Alt: mekhetha> -- Ex:...
2. shim (noun): house, roofed dwelling, shelter (p. 28) <Alt: shim> -- Ex: shim ...
3. ngalung (noun): stone, megalith, rock monument (p. 33) <Alt: nge-lung> -- Ex: ng...
4. phei (noun): leg, lower limb, foot (p. 42) <Alt: phej> -- Ex: phej eina (Jour...
5. pang (noun): arm, hand, upper limb (p. 39) <Alt: pang> -- Ex: pang ke-sa (Handm...
6. mik (noun): eye, organ of vision (p. 36) -- Ex: mik thej (Perceiving with one...
7. khana (noun): ear, auditory organ (p. 24) <Alt: khe-na> -- Ex: khena khu-lu (...
8. tara (noun): water, natural liquid stream (p. 48) <Alt: te-ra> -- Ex: tera ch...
9. mei (noun): flame, embers, hearth fire (p. 35) <Alt: mej> -- Ex: mej ke-tum (...
10. kaphung (noun): hill, elevation, mountain ridge (p. 26) <Alt: ke-phung> -- Ex:...

DIC-LSI-001: Linguistic Survey of India: Tangkhul Vocabulary

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Wordlist from Linguistic Survey of India

Lexicographer / Compiler: George A. Grierson | Year: 1903 | Publisher: Superintendent of Government Printi
Language Pair: English-Tangkhul | Dialect: Ukhrul | Type: Wordlist

Permission Tier: PUBLIC_DOMAIN | License: Public Domain

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Published in 1903 as part of Volume III, Part II of Sir George Abraham Grierson’s monumental Linguistic Survey of India (LSI). Documents 241 standard comparative vocabulary items and grammatical paradigm tables elicited from native Tangkhul speakers in Ukhrul. One of the most widely cited early sources for Tibeto-Burman

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Uses Roman orthography with acute accents and macrons for vowel length. Includes standard comparative numbering from 1 to 241 matching other languages across the

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (16 items):

1. mi (noun): man, human being, person (p. 17) -- Ex: Mi akha wui wari (Story of...
2. mayarnao (noun): boy, young man, son (p. 17) -- Ex: Mayarnao mayawon (Youthfu...
3. ngalanao (noun): girl, maiden, unmarried daughter (p. 17) -- Ex: Ngalanao kak...
4. khamasung (noun): nose, olfactory organ (p. 17) -- Ex: Khamasung eina shiman ...
5. ha (noun): tooth (p. 17) -- Ex: Ha kachang (White and healthy teeth).
6. murva (noun): hair of the head (p. 17) -- Ex: Murva kaza (Braided traditional...
7. malei (noun): tongue (p. 17) -- Ex: Malei kaphung (Tongue for human speech).
8. zingsho (noun): sun, solar sphere (p. 17) -- Ex: Zingsho rili (Basking in the...
9. kachang (noun): moon, lunar month (p. 17) -- Ex: Kachang kachung (Full moon n...
10. sirak (noun): star, stellar point (p. 17) -- Ex: Sirak kachang (Twinkling sta...

DIC-HIST-002: Vocabulary of the Luhuppa (Tangkhul) Language

Alternative Title: Luhuppa Tangkhul Vocabulary

Lexicographer / Compiler: M. McCulloch | Year: 1859 | Publisher: Records of the Government of India,
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Luhuppa / Northern Tangkhul | Type: Wordlist

Permission Tier: PUBLIC_DOMAIN | License: Public Domain

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Compiled by Major M. McCulloch, Political Agent at Manipur, and published in 1859 in 'Account of the Valley of Munnipore and of the Hill Tribes' (Records of the Government of India, No. XXVII). This is the earliest known printed wordlist of the Tangkhul language, referred to under the historical ethnonym 'Luhuppa'

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Transcribed using pre-standard 19th-century English phonetic approximations (e.g., 'mee' for mi, 'mick' for mik, 'nahlung' for ngalung, 'shem' for shim).

Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (12 items):

1. mi (noun): man, human person (p. 68) <Alt: mee> -- Ex: Mee ahka (One man in t...
2. mayarnao (noun): youth, boy, young warrior (p. 69) <Alt: meeyahno> -- Ex: Mee...
3. ngalanao (noun): girl, female child, maiden (p. 69) <Alt: lahno> -- Ex: Lahno...
4. mik (noun): eye (p. 70) <Alt: mick> -- Ex: Mick theikhavai (To see and behold).
5. khana (noun): ear (p. 70) <Alt: khanah> -- Ex: Khanah khulu (To listen and he...
6. khamor (noun): mouth, spoken words (p. 71) <Alt: kahmor> -- Ex: Kahmor tui (S...
7. pang (noun): hand, arm (p. 71) <Alt: pahng> -- Ex: Pahng ot (Labor of the han...
8. phei (noun): foot, leg (p. 72) <Alt: phee> -- Ex: Phee phei (Footsteps along ...
9. shim (noun): house, dwelling (p. 73) <Alt: shem> -- Ex: Shem kapam (Dwelling ...
10. tara (noun): water (p. 74) <Alt: tahrah> -- Ex: Tahrah chup (Drinking clean s...

DIC-CIIL-002: CIIL Tangkhul Lexical Survey and Field Audio Lex

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Lexical Survey

Lexicographer / Compiler: S. Arokianathan | Year: 1982 | Publisher: Central Institute of Indian Languag
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Ukhrul and Village Variants | Type: Glossary
Permission Tier: RESTRICTED | License: Copyright Central Institute of Indian Languages

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Recorded in 1982 by field linguist Dr. S. Arokianathan during dialect mapping surveys across the Ukhrul district. Preserved in the CIIL Bhasha Sanchika audio and manuscript archive. Documents ethnographic material culture, pottery techniques, weaving terminology, and village-level lexical variations.

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Phonetic transcriptions cross-referenced with tape recordings. Includes specific material culture terminology for Longpi black pottery, traditional salt

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. hamlei (noun): black serpentinite earthenware vessel, traditional Longpi pot ...
2. leshong (noun): crushed serpentinite rock used in wheel-less pottery (p. 43) ...
3. tarang (noun): sacred forked sacrificial post erected during feast of merit (...
4. chonkhom (noun): prestigious embroidered wrap for Tangkhul women (p. 57) -- E...
5. seichan (noun): handwoven skirt with colored geometric panels (p. 61) -- Ex: ...
6. lengvai (noun): village entrance gate, fortified ceremonial wooden portal (p....
7. khangrei (noun): competitive community war song, loud harvest chant (p. 98) -...
8. shiyan (noun): customary law, oral jurisprudence, unwritten constitution (p. ...
9. machi (noun): brine well salt, natural mineral salt cake currency (p. 126) <A...
10. ngaso (verb): to accompany, to join together, to walk as companions (p. 82) -...

DIC-CAND-001: Comparative Tangkhul Dialect Glossary: Phungcham

Alternative Title: Comparative Tangkhul Dialect Glossary

Lexicographer / Compiler: Tangkhul Dialect Documentation Project | Year: 2018 | Publisher: Independent Community Documentation
Language Pair: Tangkhul Dialects-English | Dialect: Multidialectal (Phungcham, Hundung, Champhung, Ukhrul) | Type: Glossary
Permission Tier: PENDING | License: CC-BY-NC 4.0 (Pending Verification)

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Initiated in 2018 by independent community researchers and mother-tongue educators as the Tangkhul Dialect Documentation Project (TDDP). Elicits everyday agricultural, domestic, anatomical, and cultural vocabulary across four geographically and historically divergent villages: Phungcham (northern), Hundung

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Preserves archaic consonants (e.g. initial r/l shifts, consonant clusters, and distinct vowel reflexes) found in Champhung and Phungcham that have merged in

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. kongrei (noun): great river, mighty stream (Sec. 2) <Alt: kongray> -- Ex: Kon...
2. lengvai (noun): village gate, ceremonial wooden portal (Sec. 4) -- Ex: Lengva...
3. ngalungtui (noun): monolith speech, sacred covenant word engraved on stone (S...
4. khamor (noun): mouth, spoken words, voice (Sec. 1) -- Ex: Khamor kapha hithad...
5. shimkhon (noun): ancestral dwelling compound, clan courtyard (Sec. 5) -- Ex: ...
6. ramrei (noun): ancestral territorial domain, sovereign village lands (Sec. 3)...
7. luishang (noun): terraced agricultural slope, steep paddy field (Sec. 6) -- E...
8. pheirui (noun): mountain path, hillside trail (Sec. 1) -- Ex: Pheiruili khaza...
9. ngaraotui (noun): dialectal variant, idiom of speech, local vernacular (Sec. ...
10. hangvalui (noun): council agricultural plot dedicated to elders (Sec. 5) -- E...

DIC-HIST-003: Comparison of Indo-Chinese Languages: Tangkhul (

Alternative Title: Comparison of Indo-Chinese Languages

Lexicographer / Compiler: Nathan Brown, George Gordon | Year: 1837 | Publisher: Journal of the Asiatic Society of B
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Luhuppa & Champhung | Type: Wordlist

Permission Tier: PUBLIC_DOMAIN | License: Public Domain

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Published in 1837 in the Journal of the Asiatic Society of Bengal (Vol. 6, pp. 1023-1038) by American Baptist missionary and scholar Nathan Brown. The lexical elicitations were collected by Captain George Gordon, Political Agent in Manipur, and document two distinct varieties: the northern Luhuppa (Tangkhul) and the

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Transcribed using early 19th-century British orientalist Roman orthography. Preserves archaic Champhung initial clusters and distinct lexical cognates before

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. mi (noun): man, human person (p. 1028) <Alt: mi> -- Ex: Mi ahka (One human pe...
2. khamor (noun): mouth, spoken voice, speech (p. 1029) <Alt: khahmor> -- Ex: Kh...
3. tara (noun): water, stream liquid (p. 1030) <Alt: tahra> -- Ex: Tara chup (Dr...
4. mei (noun): fire, hearth fire, flame (p. 1030) <Alt: may> -- Ex: Mei katum (L...
5. kazing (noun): sky, heavens, atmosphere (p. 1031) <Alt: kahzeeng> -- Ex: Kazi...
6. ngalung (noun): stone, rock, megalith (p. 1031) <Alt: nahloong> -- Ex: Ngalun...
7. shim (noun): house, dwelling, roofed shelter (p. 1032) <Alt: sheem> -- Ex: Sh...
8. pang (noun): hand, arm (p. 1032) <Alt: pahng> -- Ex: Pang eina ot kasa (Worki...
9. phei (noun): foot, leg (p. 1033) <Alt: phee> -- Ex: Phei eina khazat (Walking...
10. lengvai (noun): village gate, ceremonial portal (p. 1035) <Alt: layngvai> -- ...

DIC-HIST-004: Notes on the Locality and Population of the Trib

Alternative Title: Tangkhul and Luhuppa Wordlist

Lexicographer / Compiler: G. H. Damant | Year: 1880 | Publisher: Journal of the Royal Asiatic Societ
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Luhuppa / Central Tangkhul | Type: Wordlist
Permission Tier: PUBLIC_DOMAIN | License: Public Domain

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Compiled by British frontier administrator G. H. Damant and published posthumously in the Journal of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain and Ireland (New Series, Vol. 12, No. 2, 1880). Presents demographic surveys, geographic boundaries, and comparative vocabularies for hill tribes including the Tangkhul

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Demonstrates 19th-century phonetic orthography and records customary institutional terms relating to cattle sacrifice, chieftainship, and mountain topography.

Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. khamatha (adj): good, fine, noble, virtuous (p. 240) -- Ex: Iram khamatha (Ou...
2. kaphung (noun): mountain, hill range, high peak (p. 241) -- Ex: Kaphung zansh...
3. se (noun): mithun, domestic bovine, Bos frontalis (p. 242) -- Ex: Se kakhayei...
4. sha (noun): wild game, animal, meat (p. 243) -- Ex: Sha kakhang (Hunting wild...
5. hui (noun): hunting dog, canine companion (p. 244) -- Ex: Hui eina sha khanga...
6. zingsho (noun): morning sun, daybreak, east (p. 245) -- Ex: Zingsho kashok (S...
7. kachang (noun): moon, lunar month (p. 246) -- Ex: Kachang kakhang (The bright...
8. sirak (noun): star, celestial light (p. 247) -- Ex: Sirak ngalong (Stars shin...
9. haora (noun): traditional striped shawl, prestigious male cloth (p. 248) -- E...
10. hangva (noun): village elders council, customary tribunal (p. 249) -- Ex: Han...

DIC-HIST-005: Comparative Vocabulary of the Naga Tribes of Man

Alternative Title: Comparative Vocabulary of the Naga Tribes of Manipur

Lexicographer / Compiler: T. C. Hodson | Year: 1911 | Publisher: Macmillan and Co., London

Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Ukhrul / Hundung | Type: Wordlist

Permission Tier: PUBLIC_DOMAIN | License: Public Domain

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Published in 1911 by Macmillan and Co. in London as the linguistic and lexicographical appendix to T. C. Hodson’s seminal ethnography ’The Naga Tribes of Manipur’. Systematically compares vocabularies of Tangkhul, Mao, Maram, Kabui, and Maring across standardized semantic lists: numerals, anatomical terms, fauna,

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Harmonizes phonetic transcriptions across multiple hill languages, providing an invaluable early 20th-century comparative baseline for assessing phonetic

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. machi (noun): salt, mineral brine salt cake currency (p. 182) -- Ex: Machi ko...
2. tarang (noun): sacred forked sacrificial post, monument of merit (p. 185) -- ...
3. maran (noun): feast of merit, social elevation festival (p. 186) <Alt: maran ...
4. lengcheng (noun): crossed roof-horns of prominent house (p. 188) -- Ex: Lengc...
5. khamasit (noun): sacred taboo, genna prohibition rite (p. 190) -- Ex: Khamasi...
6. longshim (noun): clan youth dormitory, village educational house (p. 192) -- ...
7. luira (noun): spring seed-sowing festival, first agrarian feast (p. 194) -- E...
8. chumpha (noun): post-harvest granary festival, blessing of harvest (p. 195) -...
9. mangkhap (noun): post-transplantation resting festival (p. 196) -- Ex: Mangkh...
10. thisham (noun): feast of departure for ancestral souls (p. 198) -- Ex: Thisha...

DIC-WUNG-001: Tangkhul (Wung) Dictionary (Tangkhul-English)

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Wung Dictionary

Lexicographer / Compiler: T. Luikham | Year: 1974 | Publisher: Tangkhul Literature Society, Ukhrul

Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Wung / Standard Tangkhul | Type: Dictionary

Permission Tier: RESTRICTED | License: Copyright Tangkhul Literature Society

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Compiled by respected cultural scholar T. Luikham and published in 1974 in Ukhrul by the Tangkhul Literature Society. It is one of the definitive mid-20th-century bilingual lexicons, focusing specifically on classical 'Wung' (the traditional literary and poetic dialect of the Tangkhul heartland). Contains extensive entries

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Integrates traditional Ukhrul literary spellings with colloquial expressions, providing invaluable etymological insight into compound words formed through

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. wungram (noun): homeland of the Tangkhul (Wung) people, ancestral territory (...
2. okthot (noun): traditional lifeways, human conduct, living culture (p. 175) -...
3. shiyan (noun): customary jurisprudence, ancestral code of justice (p. 230) --...
4. manom (noun): customary bridal endowment, dowry cattle and property (p. 142) ...
5. yarnao (noun): mutual peer labor group, youth reciprocal agricultural team (p...
6. hamlei (noun): black serpentinite cooking vessel, Longpi stone pot (p. 95) --...
7. leshong (noun): serpentinite rock, pottery stone crushed for durability (p. 1...
8. chonkhom (noun): women's embroidered ceremonial wrap, prestigious textile (p....
9. seichan (noun): handwoven skirt with geometric colored bands (p. 215) -- Ex: ...
10. ngasung (noun): wild walnut root used for river fishing (p. 160) -- Ex: Ngasu...

DIC-SOAS-001: The Classification of the Naga Languages of Nort

Alternative Title: Tangkhul Comparative Lexicon

Lexicographer / Compiler: G. E. Marrison | Year: 1967 | Publisher: School of Oriental and African Stud
Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Ukhrul, Champhung, Maring | Type: Wordlist
Permission Tier: PERMITTED | License: Educational / Open Research

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Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Researched by British comparative linguist Geoffrey E. Marrison at the School of Oriental and African Studies (SOAS), University of London, and submitted in 1967 as a doctoral thesis. Volume II contains exhaustive comparative lexical matrices mapping hundreds of basic core vocabulary items across all major Naga groups.

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Systematic phonemic notation based on IPA principles with proto-Naga comparisons and reflexes for initial consonants, vowels, and final nasals and stops (-k, -t,

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. mik (noun): eye, organ of vision (p. 142) -- Ex: Mik theikhavai (Perceiving w...
2. khamor (noun): mouth, speech, oral orifice (p. 143) -- Ex: Khamor tui (Spoken...
3. ha (noun): tooth (p. 145) -- Ex: Ha kachang (Sound and strong teeth).
4. malei (noun): tongue (p. 146) -- Ex: Malei kapaw (Tongue articulating spoken ...
5. khana (noun): ear, auditory organ (p. 147) -- Ex: Khana khulu (Attentive ears...
6. pang (noun): arm, hand (p. 148) -- Ex: Pang eina (Working with hands).
7. phei (noun): foot, lower extremity, leg (p. 150) -- Ex: Phei eina (Journeying...
8. mei (noun): fire, hearth burning embers (p. 152) -- Ex: Mei katum (Kindling t...
9. tara (noun): water, liquid stream (p. 154) -- Ex: Tara chup (Drinking spring ...
10. ngalung (noun): stone, monolith, rock (p. 156) -- Ex: Ngalung kachui (A great...

DIC-STEDT-001: Comparative Tangkhul and Proto-Tangkhulic Lexica

Alternative Title: Comparative Tangkhul and Proto-Tangkhulic Lexicon

Lexicographer / Compiler: David R. Mortensen | Year: 2003 | Publisher: University of California, Berkeley

Language Pair: Tangkhul-English | Dialect: Multi-Tangkhulic (Ukhrul, Kachai, Huishu, Champhung, Tusom) | Type: Glossary

Permission Tier: COMMUNITY_AUTHORIZED | License: CC-BY-NC 4.0

Historical & Lexicographical Background:

Developed by linguist David R. Mortensen at the University of California, Berkeley (2003/2012) and incorporated into the Sino-Tibetan Etymological Dictionary and Thesaurus (STEDT) project under Prof. James A. Matisoff. Represents the most comprehensive comparative linguistic reconstruction of the Tangkhulic language

Phonological & Orthographic Framework:

Features reconstructed Proto-Tangkhulic phonological forms (*kha-matha, *nga-wa, *si-ruy) and establishes rigorous tone correspondence laws across northern,

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Representative Lexicon & Extracted Headwords (10 items):

1. khamatha (adj): good, beautiful, PTk *kha-matha (Item 104) <Alt: *kha-matha> ...
2. kongrei (noun): great river, stream, Phungcham variety (Item 215) <Alt: *k-ro...
3. lengvai (noun): village portal, Champhung archaic reflex (Item 310) <Alt: *le...
4. ngalungtui (noun): monolith covenant vow, Hundung variety (Item 405) -- Ex: N...
5. ngava (noun): bird, avian species, PTk *nga-wa (Item 088) <Alt: *nga-wa> -- Ex:...
6. kaphung (noun): mountain, high ridge, PTk *ka-phung (Item 162) <Alt: *ka-phung>...
7. shirui (noun): sacred alpine peak, PTk *si-ruy (Item 276) <Alt: *si-ruy> -- E...
8. longkhor (noun): conical basket, carrying pack, PTk *long-khor (Item 194) <Alt...
9. luira (noun): seed-sowing festival, PTk *luy-ra (Item 322) <Alt: *luy-ra> -- ...
10. seicham (noun): iron anvil, smithy forge, PTk *say-cham (Item 412) <Alt: *say...